

The most famous cyphers

CTC IV is a big deal for us this month, and since everyone is in a mood for some "cryptanalysis", we thought we'd compile a list of some of the world's greatest cyphers and the stories behind them. Read on to learn more...

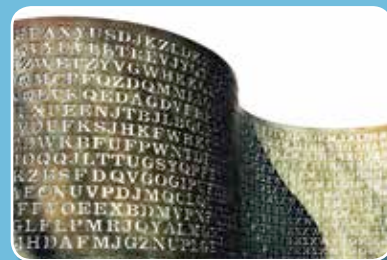
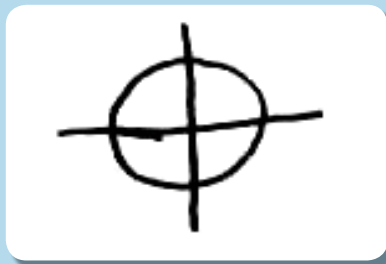


The Voynich manuscript

This 600 year old manuscript has been the source of much controversy. Containing a large number of drawings of various plants and tiny humans, the actual purpose of this manuscript is unknown. There are many people in who now believe that this script is unsolvable. Do you disagree? Try your hand at it and find out.

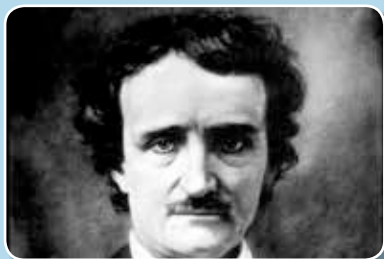
The Zodiac killer

A killer who claims that he kills people so as to have slaves in the afterlife, not to mention his own pleasure, must have had a really twisted mind. This man was a maniac but he might have been a brilliant one at that. The only clues to his real identity were the encrypted messages he left behind. Only one has been deciphered so far!



Kryptos

This is the name of a sculpture that was placed outside the CIA headquarters in Langley. Embedded in this sculpture are four separate clues, only three of which have been solved so far. The best minds at the CIA, not to mention the mathematicians around the world, have tried to solve it and failed. Can you do any better? Go on. Make your country proud.

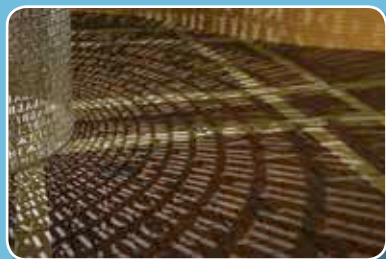


Edgar Allan Poe

A famous author, and now in the spotlight for the recent movie, Raven, Edgar Allan Poe was mad about cryptology. He challenged readers to send him cyphers, offering rewards and subscriptions to those who could send him unsolvable ones. Before he died however, he left behind two cyphers, these took the world 150 years to solve.

The Cyrillic projector

This was a cypher created by Jim Sanborn, the same guy who created the Kryptos cypher. Seemingly impossible to solve, this cypher was finally solved in 2003 with help from the guys from the kryptos project. Though the cypher has been cracked, you can still try your hand at it just for kicks. Hint: Just make sure you speak Russian.



The Oak Island treasure

A bottomless pit filled with treasure, that's what this is. Or people think it is. A group of kids stumbled across a pit on Oak island, Nova Scotia, and when they started digging, uncovered an encrypted message that seemed to indicate the presence of gold! 200 years later, no one has been able to reach the bottom of that pit, and it isn't just because it's deep.